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Editor's Note

It was only a few months ago when the scorching heat of the hottest summer in decades brought streams of sweat pouring down our faces. The horrible heatwave has now given way to the refreshing breeze of autumn, signaling the peak of fall semester as students busy themselves with midterm exams or college applications. As a senior living through her very last semester in KMLA with more time on her hands than usual, I've been able to reminisce about my past three years in this nature-friendly, but not so student-friendly school.

KMLA is a place where the iconic slogan 'bba-jol-dap' (the answer is graduating as fast as possible) prevails. It's a place where my friends have cried themselves to sleep in exhaustion, desperation, and fear; I cannot say that I haven't as well. But don't get me wrong. Our school is also a place teeming with opportunities readily provided to those who seek them. Playing basketball until 12:00 in the morning, visiting Laos to meet the world's cutest kids, or publishing our wonderful team's articles in the school newspaper aren't everyday experiences for most high school students. Neither is reading favorite books in college-level literature courses or learning how to write 10-page long history papers in five days.

I cannot say with more confidence that my three years in KMLA have been both rewarding and fulfilling, as I'm sure will be for all of you. This edition of the Minjok Herald explores the different meanings behind the word 'KMLA-ian' by stepping into the shoes of 6 students and teachers whom our crew deemed exemplified the KMLA spirit. The six definitions were far from identical; we are sure yours will differ, too. If there is anything we learned from this experience, it's that no one deserves to be sitting where you are, reading this paper more than you do. We hope the sincere words of friends and teachers could, once again, invigorate those draining in the debilitating wave of academics, responsibilities, and relationships.

It has truly been an honor and happiness working as the Editor-in-Chief of the Minjok Herald for the past year. I want to give a big shout out to my crew and teachers who have been more cooperative and helpful than I could have ever asked for. With the best regards to our next chief editor, Choi In-seo, the Minjok Herald always promises to be a herald of change for the better—for our school and our students. Thank you.

Oh Yoon-jin
Editor-in-Chief
Sept. 20th, 2018

Please note that this edition is the 59th edition. The previous edition published on April 22nd, 2018 (58th edition) has been misprinted as the 59th; we apologize for the inconvenience. Thank you.

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Special thanks to
Baek Ji-Ho(B) for Photos

Ms. Park Mi-Hyang

KMLA'S NEW NUTRITIONIST

With the official start of the first semester of 2018, the school nutritionist Mrs. Kim Min-Sun left the school, and in her place, KMLA greeted Miss Park Mi-Hyang. Fortunately, Minjok Herald had the opportunity to have an interview with her about herself, her plans for the school, and the food in KMLA.

MH Hello! Can you briefly introduce yourself?

Hi, my name is Park Mi Hyang, the new school nutritionist. I majored in food and nutrition at my university, and after working as a nutritionist at an industrial university and PyeongChang High School, I'm here in KMLA. In KMLA, I will most importantly be planning the monthly menu. Besides that, I'll be calculating and adjusting the school food budget, and periodically checking the sanitation of the kitchen and cafeteria.



MH Have you found anything different about being a nutritionist in KMLA compared to in other schools?

One thing I realized was that KMLA's meal plans are quite liberated from the government. In many other schools, the Department of Education supervises the school food budget and menu, but KMLA is free from those interferences. The government actually bans ramen in school meals, which we have now and then. I think KMLA takes into consideration that students do not leave school much and tries to prepare diverse meals. I have also noticed that there are quite a lot of side dishes per meal.

Another thing I found unique was the self-serving system. Unlike other schools, where the lunch ladies distribute at least the main menu, KMLA has no lunch ladies distributing food for the students. I agree that the school should give students the freedom to choose what they eat, but there's a big problem here—food waste. It's hard to estimate the amount of leftover food for every meal. While sometimes there are more leftovers of a certain menu than we expected, other times there are almost none. We can't only make food that students like, so we're facing quite a dilemma. But you should be aware that the food waste generated from the school should be dealt with inside the school—this can be problematic if we have too much waste.

MH Do you have any plans as a nutritionist in KMLA?

I think the most important task of a nutritionist is to make healthy but tasty meals so that the students can enjoy eating for their own good. Currently, I'm communicating with the lunch ladies, bakers, some teachers and the Student Department of Food and Nutrition to plan the menu. But I plan to make a small suggestion box in the cafeteria to hear the opinions of more students and teachers. It will be placed on the table in front of the main elevator of the cafeteria around April or May. You can put in the box opinions on the overall menu, dishes you would like to eat, proposals or critiques to the cafeteria. Though it will be very hard to satisfy every single student, I'll read all the opinions meticulously, so please use the box actively.

I also plan to ensure the hygiene of the school cafeteria. I'll start with small rule changes, like wiping the catering cars during intervals between teacher and student meal times, and receiving hygiene education with the lunch ladies at least once a month.

MH Is there anything you want to tell the KMLAians?

Well, there are things I didn't realize when I was a student but started to deeply sympathize with after I became a nutritionist. Wherever I go, I find that students don't eat a lot of vegetables. I understand that they're not that appealing, but I hope you can consider your health as well and eat them. Also, I know students here have a hard time living in a dormitory school without even a convenience store, but food from outside really could be dangerous, so please try to enjoy your school meals! Honestly, I feel sad too when students don't eat well or dislike the menu. So please enjoy your meals and give me active feedback! I'll do my best to reflect your suggestions and come up with healthy and tasty meals.

MH Thank you for your time, and welcome to KMLA!

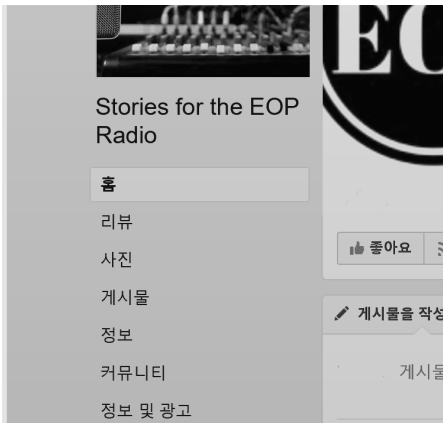
Senior Writer
Kim Soo-Min

THE STORY BEHIND

The Newest Radio in School

Keep EOP!

This is one of the most commonly spoken sentences in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. English Only Policy (EOP), applied to students who are at school, requires students to speak English during school hours, except when students study in the Culture Center. As KMLA continuously emphasizes that English is only a tool,



not an end in itself, the EOP encourages students to speak English on a daily basis so that they would be able to fluently communicate with people from all over the world.

However, students who speak Korean seem to be ubiquitous nowadays. Much Korean is heard in the chitchat during recess, albeit the teachers' efforts to regulate it. In the international field, conversations in English frequently take place; they are more comfortable with speaking English and also keen to practice English to prepare for their college life abroad. However, not only is conversational English deemphasized in Korea's educational curriculum, more and more students feel uncomfortable conversing in English. EOP has become a nominal policy. 22nd waver Sim Kee-Whan, the director of the department of English Only Policy, emphasized that the only way to familiarize students with English speaking is to keep the EOP.

The department of EOP has previously attempted many policies to foster English speaking, much to its lack of success. Last year, the department initiated a policy called EOP promoter. A student per class would be secretly selected as the promoter, and would be given the job to promote English speaking for a week. If his or her classmates correctly identify the promoter at the end of the week



through an online survey, the promoter would get a reward point. Class students who correctly identified the promoter multiple times would also be rewarded with a point. Yet, as promoters started to abuse the policy by revealing themselves to the whole class, the department was eventually forced to abandon the policy.

The newest solution of the department, started only months ago, is a radio broadcast during lunchtime. As students leave their dormitory for afternoon classes, the department members would introduce a story submitted by students who violated the EOP. Along with the story, they would play an English pop song.

The new change was initially met with much opposition. Anonymous students complained that they were



being deprived of their rightful sleep during lunchtime because of the loud music. Yet, the department swiftly communicated with the students and reached a compromise to reduce the volume and continue the radio. The radio has continued to bring good music to our ears ever since.

After the peaceful resolution, Sim has plans ahead for new polices, including celebrating an EOP holiday and activating the EOP Facebook page. With these new policies, the Department of EOP hopes that students would familiarize themselves with speaking English. Ultimately, a proclivity of KMLA will change.

Senior Writer
Kim Rak-Young



Swipe to Enter!

During the first semester, KMLA announced a sudden change in its security policies and distributed new student ID cards to its students and teachers. They were to use these new cards that contain electric chips to enter the Deokgo House and the English Center. The cards had to be swiped on an authorizing device attached on the entrances of each building during school hours. Many students expressed mild surprise and confusion at the fact that they would need their cards even when they left their dormitory for the smallest of reasons, such as taking out their trash.

"This upcoming policy is a response to the increasing outsider access of the school," says Mr. Choi Kyung-Jong, the Director of the Administration Office. According to Mr. Choi, the parking barrier gates located near the entrance of the school campus initially served to restrict outsiders stepping into school grounds without permission. Yet, as the barrier gates could only restrict vehicles, it failed to prevent outsiders from casually walking into the school undiscovered. The new policy was the solution to such safety problems and ensure that students and teachers would not be threated or harassed by strangers.

The policy, before its initiation in May, has gone through feedback processes from teachers, employees, and students. While students argue that they were simply notified of the change without participating in the decision-making process, most seem to generally approve of its necessity.

However, over the months of its implementation, several technical loopholes have been reported. Students are increasingly discovering creative ways to bypass the rigid locks of closed doors with only their hands; some don't even carry around their cards during the day. Not only that, they complain that the door-opening process is simply troublesome and inconvenient. Some students who step out of the dormitory to take out the trash forget to bring their cards with them; they are oftentimes seen waiting for other friends to pass by to come to their rescue. Baffled parents who are denied access into the buildings are also seen standing outside closed doors, waiting for help like a stranded dog.

Although such inconveniences are yet to be solved, Mr. Choi noted that the school was deliberate to consider this agenda carefully since last year. As much as ample thought was put into its implementation, the change indeed seems to have enhanced the safety of the school campus, as identity authorization is a prerequisite to entering any school building.

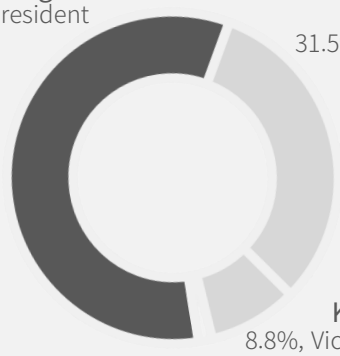
Senior Writer
Kim Hyun-Jun

25th Student Council Election

EXECUTIVE COUNCIL

Yoon Jeong-Jun
58.1%, President

An Ju-Eon
31.5%, Vice President



Kim Min-Ji
8.8%, Vice President

Choi Hyeok-Jung
39.2%, Council Member

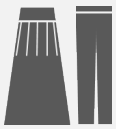
Kim Yeon-Seo
38.7%, Council Member

1 AN JU-EON



- Student Petition System
- Replacement of Old Facilities

2 KIM MIN-JI



- Potential Solution for Girls' Uniform
- Morning Speech

3 YOON JEONG-JUN

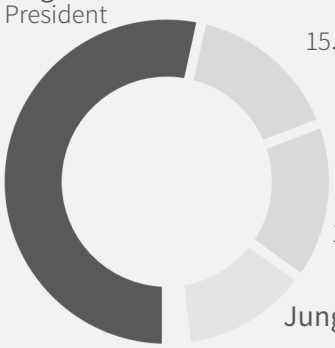


- New Food Delivery System
- Student Welfare
- Solution for Charger Rental System

LEGISLATIVE COUNCIL

Lee Seung-Min
53.4%, President

Lee Young-Heon
15.8%, Vice President

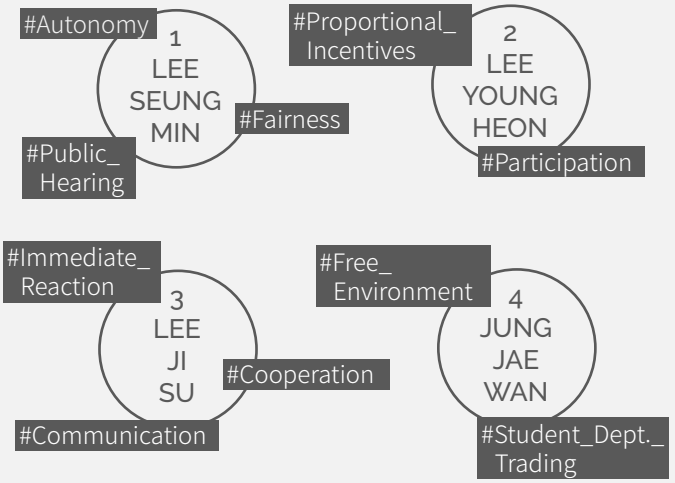


Lee Ji-Su
15.8%, Vice President

Jung Jae-Wan
13.1%

Jeon Seung-Min
Approved, Council Member

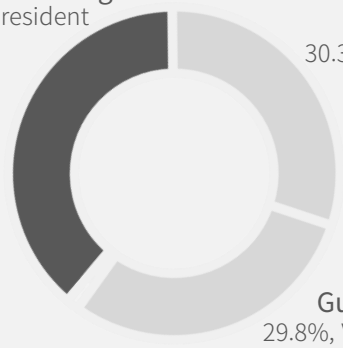
Choi Seo-Hee
Approved, Council Member



JUDICIAL COUNCIL

Kim Chae-Young
38.7%, President

Lee Hyun-Seo
30.3%, Vice President



Gum Mun-Soo
29.8%, Vice President

1 GUM MUN-SOO

#TRUST #RIGHTS #STUDENT-CENTERED

- Organization of Precedent Decisions
- Priority on Testimony
- Additional Punishment

2 LEE HYUN-SEO

#TRUST #CHANGE #COMMUNICATION

- Priority for One-Point-Indicted Students
- Elaboration of "Did Not Follow Teacher's Directions"
- Incentive System

3 KIM CHAE-YOUNG

#BALANCE #COMPROMISE

- Organization of Precedent Decisions
- Allowance of Absence for Students Judged Innocent
- Stipulation of Unwritten Rules

FEAT

What Does It Mea





As students and faculty members come and go every year on this isolated countryside campus, there are some that leave a unique mark of their own. In some cases, their heroic tales of life in school—or their 'KMLAian-ness'—are discussed wave after wave, influencing generations of newcomers that aspire to make the most out of their stint at KMLA. In this edition of the Minjok Herald, the Feature Crew explores the stories of several members of the KMLA family who have become an integral part of the community, earning the reputable title of a 'true KLMAian.' Their own takes how they define life in KMLA—be it with their academic zeal, outstanding leadership, or unflinching passion—will no doubt serve as an exemplar for many underclassmen to chase after.

TURE

n To Be a KMLAian?





MEETING 20TH WAVER

SEO JAE-HYUN

KMLA'S GREATEST FILMMAKER

Seo Jae-Hyun is a graduate of KMLA who is soon to attend Columbia University in New York. He is passionate about film-making and aspires to be a movie director in the future.

1. Why do you think you were chosen as an exemplary KMLAian?

It feels a bit awkward to toot my own horn, but I guess it's related to my passion in filmmaking, though there are many more who are smarter than me. We face so many choices in this school, whether they be classes or club activities. When faced with such choices, I think I always made it a priority to make sure the small steps I take each time connect to my ultimate goal. I tried to be constantly aware of where in life I was headed and live so that would not be ashamed at myself when I looked back.

One of the words that have always been associated to KMLA is 'vision.' Years ago, when I first met and fell for KMLA through its appearance in media, I was amazed at the people with great aspirations who designed their own future and lived fiercely for it. Also, the school motto on our backpack says, 'leaders in various fields and levels;' I loved a place with such a colorful mix of dreams. However, as in all media, there were aspects that were not really the same as they were shown, and I think many students were disillusioned by the reality. I truly felt their disappointment, but I nevertheless tried to live up to my dreams. And I was given so many opportunities! In the end, I do not regret my time in school. Having chosen a somewhat minor route and having pushed through it may be a reason for such an impression if someone thought of me as an exemplary KMLAian.

2. What do you think is the way to be passionate about something? Knowing what you want to do and finding the way to do it isn't always easy.

As I said before, I think we should learn to deliberate on even our smallest decisions. It is similar to the production of a movie; the smallest details form the mood of the movie and eventually constitute a big trunk of the story. The collection of small and big choices during your three years in KMLA determines how you graduate in the end. So, I always reminded myself to stay alert and awake! Because the school is such a busy place, simply coping with the tasks that are given to you can be challenging. I really had to concentrate on every moment of my life so as not to lose my bigger picture. When I was participating in club activities, I tried to follow my passion rather than its less demanding, 'honey-sucking' comfort. Although I can't say that I have a special way of following my passion, it seems to me that the smallest time and energy spent to contemplate these issues can make a big difference in the end.

3. What parts of you do you think make you a 'KMLAian'? What are the other parts that don't?

Well, even in my own eyes think, I was especially vicious in my pursuit for my dream. It is not easy to pursue a same goal for about ten years, you know. However, I don't believe at all that this is the only definition of passion, or of an admirable dream! For example, one of my friends in the 20th wave came to KMLA as a history major, and was then mesmerized in physics after his first physics class. He took time to reconsider his major and ultimately changed his main interest, going to Oxford with a major in physics in the end. From what I heard from him, his definition of passion isn't about acquiring a specific title such as a historian or a physician, but immersing in the field that he enjoys. For him, changing his major to physics was his act of passion and consistency! I think a true KMLAian is anyone who has their own philosophy and consistently follows the path that fits it, not only those who envision a specific major or a job.

If I had always lived as I have spoken above, I would qualify for a thousand praises, but there were many moments when I did not live like that. Reasons for it may be laziness or the temptation to



Photo Credit: Jung Sang-Min, 20th waver

stay in a comfort zone. But when I look back now, I think it was the university admission process that made me hesitate more than anything else. Even as someone who always tried to spread the mantra that 'your college does not define your life,' college admissions loomed over me like a huge wall. As well as the burden of the SAT / AP / GPA, college admissions is representative of our world's emphasis on tangible achievement. My passion wobbled with the stress of getting into college. While I disliked my own doubts and regrets, I could not help asking myself what I had achieved when my friends brought back awards from MUN or Mock Trial. (Until I received an award in a film festival just before the Early admissions process, I had no awards outside of school.)

I think the same will apply to many students. Even though college admissions for international students are relatively liberal, students are forced to fit themselves into the criteria of the world and sell 'a bigger picture.' I would reject these statements all the time: "This university likes this type of a student." "One of your seniors who went to this college highlighted these points in his/her essay; you should try the same." Sadly, it was not something I could completely avoid. I think universities as a milestone inevitably corrupts our symbolic school value of studying for the sake of studying. I'm sure everyone would empathize. Though I just dove head-first into the application process to simple 'do as I wished' (and fortunately got good results), I feel bad that the inevitable future of all Korean high-school students clouding the identity of KMLA.

4. How would you define a true 'KMLAian?' Tell us whether if it is something worth pursuing, if so, why, and how we can pursue the ideal.

My definition of a 'KMLAian' is still 'vision.' By vision, I mean a clear ambition and attitude in life! Honestly, the idea of 'national leadership' or 'the bright fatherland of tomorrow' in our school motto still does not resonate with me—it's kinda outdated too. I was more moved by the belief that we should 'study for sake of learning' and 'walk the path of your interest and aptitude'. In 2016, an alumnus suggested a new motto for the KMLA family during the twentieth anniversary ceremony of our school. I think this is a great example of how our school should re-establish its identity.

As members of KMLA
who carry the school motto
in our hearts,
Let us be creative individuals
who do not reside in the present
but move steadily forward.

Let us become leaders
in various fields and levels
where we devote ourselves
to our fatherland and humanity.
This is the true path that
a KMLA student should follow,
and this is our pride.

5. Finally, does being a KMLAian has a meaning outside of school? If it does, what would it be?

I would say it truly does! It never means that you should be swept away with the pride of being in KMLA, but your first-hand experience in KMLA will inevitably influence your future life in unpredictable forms. After all, KMLA is a place where we formulated our sets of values while going through a big transition in life. My definition of a "KMLAian' is a person with vision, but my passion will always be displayed outside of the boundaries of our school.

Thank you so much for your interview!

Senior Writers
Youn Youn-Ji
Eom Tae-Kyung

MEETING 21ST WAVER

HWANG YEONG-JUN

HOW TO RESPECT OTHERS



Photo: Interviewee (right) and his schoolmate (left)

1. Why do you think you were recommended as a "true KMLAian"?

I heard that my friends recommended me, but I'm honestly not sure if I really deserve such title. I guess my friends nominated me because I was able to help them in some way or other.

2. What do you think makes you a "true KMLA student"? Or what doesn't?

I think I fit the KMLAian ideal in that I show respect to others. However, I sometimes fail to do that. For example, I slept in a class because I was too tired. I was disrespectful to the teacher.

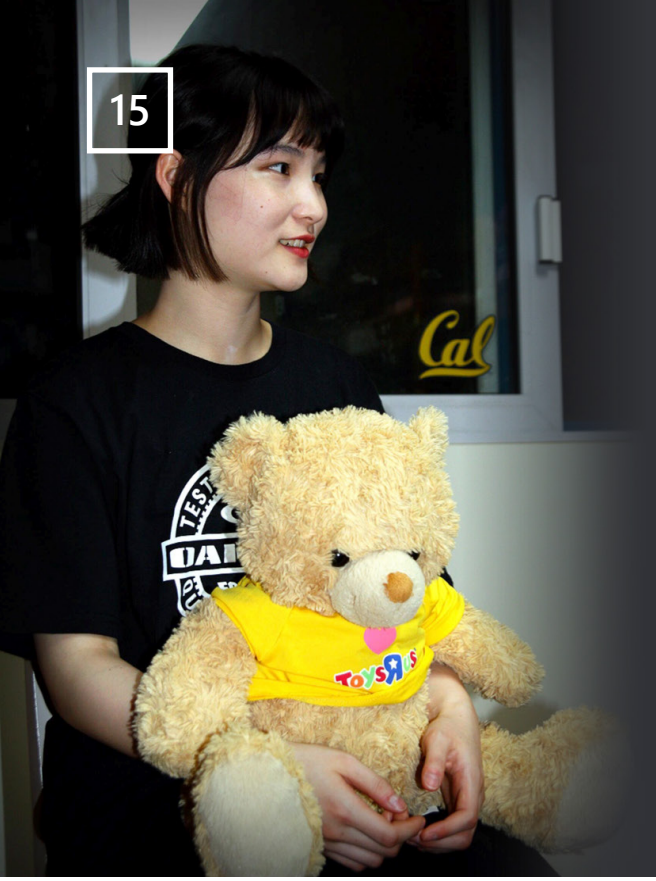
3. What does it mean to be a "true KMLAian"? Should we pursue the values of a 'KMLAian?' How can we acquire them?

Before I enrolled in KMLA, I thought a 'true KMLAian' referred to a student who could independently study and pursue his or her academic interests with passion. However, it felt wrong looking at smart, impolite students. Being a true KMLA student is more than being able to study well—it's about having good character. I think character is what differentiates KMLA students from others. Yes, a true KMLA student is someone who not only studies hard but is also respectful toward others. KMLA emphasizes such value by encouraging students to greet each other with a bow. I really like this tradition. Furthering the respect students show others, I want students to be more altruistic and generous towards their peers.

KMLA students generally have very good character, but I think they tend to be impolite when lecturers visit our school. Hundreds of students doze off in front of them, and it's very rude. It's a habit we should definitely get rid of.

I know sleep is precious to KMLAians. I also know how sleep is alluring and inescapable when it hits you. But students should at least think about the teachers (or lecturers), try to stay awake, and feel apologetic when they cannot help but doze off. Some do not care and even go so far as to snore in class. This is obviously very disrespectful to the person who is talking, who is also probably much older than them. In short, I want everyone to think in the other person's shoes. This is the most important quality of being a true KMLAian.

Senior Writer
Lee Ji-Yin



MEETING 21ST WAVER

PARK CHAE-WON

HOW TO EMBRACE DIFFERENCES

I've never really considered myself to be someone that people look up to, but for some reason it seems that they do. I think it is because of my experience of taking a year off, as I was given the chance to look back at myself and my life. Some see it as an advantage, and I do agree that I did have more time for reflection.

Before taking a year off, I felt constant frustration at the everyday problems of all KMLAians—studying, grades, and relationships. But I soon realized how meaningless everything was, as being here in the first place was a big opportunity—a start to something great. At least, if we were to be aware of it. I tried to expose myself to different opportunities, not only limiting myself under the pressure to get good grades. I decided to follow my heart.

> "It's **okay** to be **not okay!**"

Yes, the school can sometimes be a cruel place. Especially because students live together in a dormitory, there are constant conflicts, and fragments of truth are distorted and exaggerated into lies. That's what dormitory life is. But the real problem is that within such conflicts, people are so hostile toward each other. Of course, it is indeed difficult to keep a straight face when you hear that the person in front of you is spreading bad rumors about you. But in a place like KMLA, you shouldn't believe everything you hear. So, I think we should learn to embrace. Conflicts are inevitable because we're all different. We should learn to acknowledge these differences to try and see things the way they are—as one family and as future leaders of the nation and the world.

As you know, many people say that KMLA is a miniature version of the real world. We experience failure or sadness earlier, whether they come from grades or relationships. They oftentimes overburden and hurt us. And we learn. Because KMLAians are in this together, no one should be treated as an outcast. No one deserves to be left out just because they act differently. We can't all be the same; we don't fit into one perfect mold. And though the unique colors of ours may arouse conflict, we must learn how to mix these colors and make harmony from diversity. Just like a painting becomes more vivid with the mixture of different colors, people do too.

And for everyone who are still going through rough times, I'd like to say a word; Believe in yourself. No matter how hurt you are, appreciate yourself. I want you to remember that you matter, even when you feel like your life is falling apart. There is no shame in being hurt, or even in acknowledging the sadness in your life. And it's okay to be not okay. I just want you to take time to confront your emotions, not shut them out. Then you will be more comfortable in embracing your real and true self.

Senior Writer
Nam Hyun-Soo

MEETING 22ND WAVER

YOUN YOUN-JI

THE MESSAGE BEHIND KMLA'S ACADEMICS



1. In what ways do you think KMLA befits you?

When I first aspired to enter this school, I was captivated by the thought that I would be able to think of myself as a scholar and "study for the sake of learning." However, when I started school here, I began to realize that I was not determined enough to take the path to make such an impression last. That's why I want to keep trying and keep in mind that every choice that I make directs toward my eventual objective. I share my opinions and write constantly, striving to understand myself and the world; this is an invaluable experience. Wouldn't enjoying all this suit the KMLA-ian image?

2. KMLA students often use the phrase 'KMLAian.' What values do you think this word embraces?

When someone is called a 'KMLAian', I think that person is someone who constantly pursues what he or she wants—a person who questions ironies within aspirations and strives to solve them. A person who not only preaches what he/she thinks is important but shows personal devotion to proving its significance. Only when you pursue your belief can you find the strength to commit to your responsibilities and motivate others. Those who seek what they wish for are not only faithful to themselves, but also positively influence those around them. Wouldn't these people be what we call 'KMLAian's?' There are so many people in KMLA that touch me with their good-naturedness, and I would be grateful if I was one of them, too.

3. What do you think are things that students can learn only in KMLA?

My answer is actually inspired by a question Mr. Oh Byeong-Moon asked students in the international field a few days ago. If someone asks me why KMLA is special, I want to tell them that it is because KMLA is a school rich in its values. There are no boundaries of acquirable knowledge, smart students have debates with each other in and out of classrooms, and passionate teachers willingly provide even the most trivial advice to anyone who wants it. Beneath this culture is a common, ideal goal—we strive to pursue our aptitude and talent over the sake of success to become leaders in diverse fields. I don't think that such ideals should be separated from reality. I love that our school is a place where students can muster up the courage to pursue, actualize, and even criticize such ideals.

4. Please give some advice to the 23rd wavers on becoming a true 'KMLAian.'

If you keep in mind your aspirations when you first stepped into this school, you'll be able to pursue your goals without self-compromise and justification. You may first think, 'Wow, I'm so glad I got into one of the best high schools in Korea,' but you should remember that the foundation of your pride comes from recognizing the school's academic ideals—to study for the sake of studying and become a leader. Define your own values and make according decisions!

Senior Writer
Jang Hyun-Bin



MEETING MR. CHOI GWAN-YOUNG

KMLA'S ACTING HEADMASTER AND KOREAN LANGUAGE TEACHER

1. Why do you think you were recommended to talk about this topic?

Well, I've been in KMLA from its start, and I'm also one of the very few teachers who have worked with the founder himself. I guess many people know that I agree with the founder's intention in establishing this school.

2. What do you think a 'true KMLAian' should be like?

I think the core idea of being a KMLAian lies in the values the school pursues. When the founder established KMLA, he wanted to build a school that educates talented and patriotic students who would grow up to become the leaders in different fields of society. This is well shown in the school motto, as you all know. According to the motto, being a KMLAian means that you make an effort to contribute to the betterment of the people who have long shared the same culture and language in the Korean peninsula. The school motto also indicates that KMLA students should not only think of their own good but should also try their best to help others. The founder used to say that there is nothing more satisfying than your efforts contributing to the betterment of society. So, you could say that happiness, as a KMLAian, is not putting personal values as your ultimate goal. It is pursuing something you love and helping others at the same time.

3. Are there any figures KMLA students can learn from to pursue the values you have mentioned?

I would like to talk about three people. Dasan Jeong Yak-Yong, Chungmoo Yi Sun-Shin, and Yi Wan-Yong. For General Yi Sun-Shin, he was a leader with great wisdom and courage who sacrificed himself for the good of his own people. For Jeong Yak-Yong, he is sometimes merely known as a Confucian scholar. However, it is important to note that his efforts were directed toward bettering society by applying knowledge in real life. The third person I would like to have KMLA students keep in mind is Yi Wan-Yong, who once fought for Korean independence during its colonial era. He was a smart elite who received modern education in the United States. However, his decision to sign the Eulsa Treaty that subjugated Korea to Japan made countless Koreans suffer for decades. I hope KMLA students would learn from him that the talented should be responsible for making thoughtful and wise decisions.

4. What would you like to tell our students about the values of a true KMLAian?

I think it is a problem if students are too concerned with their grades that they choose not to participate in a variety of activities. Being a high school student, there are numerous opportunities in which you can challenge yourself. I don't believe throwing away those possibilities is the best choice you can make. Considering something other than your grades as happiness—wouldn't that be another essential trait of a true KMLAian?

Senior Writer
Kim Ga-Eun

FEATURE

MEETING

MRS. HWANG SO-HEE

KMLA'S PROUD GRADUATE AND POLITICAL SCIENCE TEACHER



Photo Credit: Baek Ji-Ho(B), 23rd waver



1. You have been recommended as a true KMLAian in Minjok Herald. Why do you think you were recommended?

I guess it's mainly due to my image of a KMLA graduate. Personally, I feel heavy responsibility as a graduate as well as a teacher. Being a KMLA graduate gives students the impression that I am always correct and moral in every aspect. However, I may still have incorrect or incomplete ideas about the spirit of our school. I genuinely feel thankful to students who respect me nevertheless.

2. Life in KMLA gives lots of new opportunities for students, but at the same time presents numerous hardships. What do you think is the hardest obstacle that students experience in KMLA?

I can think of the following two points: first, assuming reality, and second, time management in tight schedules. Bearing excessive responsibilities at a young age opens eyes to the harsh reality of the world. Leadership positions also oppress students. Teachers tell them, 'You should have done it. It was your duty. Such situations automatically evoke the anger and discontent from students. Not only that, such overburdening leads to time shortage. Because students have lots of assignments and extracurricular activities on their plate, time is inevitably limited. Given such dire circumstances, consequences of failure are left up to the students' sole responsibilities. Though this is an immense stress factor, I strongly believe these hardships can simultaneously help the students' future as well.

3. KMLA has its own unique and distinct characteristics. What do you think being a KMLAian means? Do you think that such aspects can help students overcome difficulties?

It depends on one's interpretation and values. I think it is the capacity of students to go beyond their minimum duties requirements. KMLAians should not only limit themselves to fulfilling given assignments, but should continuously expand and challenge their capabilities. Aiming for the highest ultimately leads to a life of virtue, as students are given opportunities to possess finer characteristics and ultimately gain respect from others. Their initial burden will eventually affect them positively by ameliorating their own attitudes.

4. What can students learn from KMLA? How can it relate to being a true KMLAian?

I guess most KMLA students know I am a big fan of Rousseau. I was attracted to Rousseau due to his concept of an 'ideal society.' When I first came to this school, I imagined intense competition and an inevitable obsession in grades and rankings. I also thought that students would frequently be disrespectful towards each other due to their high self-esteem. However, the reality was different; because students had different academic interests, they could learn from each other and respect their peer's strengths. Consequentially, the meaning of class rankings broke into pieces. Distinct interests in diverse subjects allowed students to cooperate humbly. KMLA's peer learning structure will enhance students' abilities in becoming more open-minded. It will also strengthen the required leadership and collaboration skills as future leaders, which simultaneously meets the high standards as a KMLAian as well.

5. Lastly, do you have any advice for students confronting numerous hardships?

In a moment of tiredness and sadness, do not keep it to yourself. Approach close teachers. They are always there to help you. Obstacles are inevitable for development, but it does not mean we should tackle them on our own. Why don't you approach the teachers around you instead of waiting and expecting them to recognize your hardships? This is one of the best ways to solve your problems wisely.

Senior Writer
Yoon Hyo-Seo

> "In a moment of tiredness and sadness, **Do not keep** it to yourself."

EDITORIAL

American artist Andy Warhol once said,
"They say time changes things, but you actually have to change them yourself."
Indeed, in the eye of the hurricane of KMLA's advancements lies the loving eyes of
our students and teachers who are not afraid to fight for what is right.
It is through such constructive criticism that any organization is able to change for the better.
The editorial crew of Minjok Herald suggests three forward steps for KMLA,
addressing student council qualifications, in-school feminism movements,
and the annual trekking program for incoming freshmen.



Photo Credit:
Sosari Project

IT'S TOO COLD TO HIKE FOR A DAY!

Every year after the orientation month of February, the incoming freshmen are asked to rate the overall quality of all orientation programs. Surprisingly, the 22nd wavers ranked the infamous trekking program as one of the top 3 most satisfactory experiences, after which the program was nicely passed down to the 23rd wavers. Not only that, the two-hour hike has been extended to a day-long trip around the wilderness of the school. Though the genuinity of the survey answers remains a question, much dissatisfaction has arisen among freshmen with this change.

The trekking program serves to introduce incoming students to the landscape around the school and boost their physical strength. As a long-lasting tradition of KMLA, it very much allows for the appreciation of nature, good health, and gain after pain. Yet, many pointed out that the program itself was too long. Roads around the campus are mostly unpaved and covered in snow in February, making trekking quite difficult. Walking for hours on slippery dirt is much more demanding than walking around a neat asphalt road. An anonymous 23rd waver complained, "I kept falling down, my legs hurt so badly, and the roads were icy". Many students were reported to have been injured from slipping on icy roads when they were physically drained. Some were later seen wearing casts around campus—we all know how critical a leg injury is in KMLA life!

The biggest complaint was the unbearable weather. A typical February in Hoengsong involves icy-cold wind, frozen snow, and below-zero temperatures. Students reported to have shivered all day long, after which many of them caught a cold. A 23rd waver complained, "If the school schedules a day-long program like this, I wish they would at least schedule it on days when the weather isn't as bad." Though the administrative process requires all programs to be planned beforehand, much to the students' understanding, they hope that the school could be more flexible in adjusting schedules. For example, programs can be switched so that students could go trekking on warmer days. With unpaved roads and the snowy weather, the freshmen's trekking turned out to be rather disastrous contrary to KMLA's well-meaning intention.

The finale of the trekking program was the welcoming ceremony, to which all juniors and seniors were required to attend. They were to wait around the school track until the freshmen made their way back into the school. As they walk into the school field, juniors and seniors would surprise their exhausted peers with a drink and a chocolate snack. Understandably, such a surprise event holds much meaning as it could strengthen bonds between the freshmen and the other students. However, some objection arose from the upperclassmen, as they were left to shiver outside for an hour and soak their socks in melted snow. An anonymous 21st waver stated, "As much as I wholeheartedly understand the school's intention of greeting the freshmen after a long, tiring day, I think there were other alternatives available." Had the event took place in the Dasan or Chungmoo Hall or in front of the dormitory, students would not have had to suffer in the cold for so long, as well as avoid the long climb back up to the dormitory from the soccer field.

The trekking program means to introduce the beautiful scenery around campus to the freshmen soon to be part of KMLA's family, while also inducing their appreciation of health and hard work. While it is indeed a refreshing experience to many students, more flexibility and modifications can be appreciated for a more enjoyable, less exhausting day.

Senior Writer
Ryu Hyun-Woo



THE SCARLET LETTER OF PENALTY RECORDS

School rules have recently been revised by the 24th legislative council to allow students to erase penalty records given by the student guidance committee. Though there was some controversy with this change, the provisions fortunately took place without much fuss and attention. However, several problems have begun to surface with this recent change, starting with the elections for the 25th student council.

Last year, a candidate was disqualified from running for a position in the student body due to penalty records. This year, due to the change in legislation, candidates could run in elections if their records of being penalized by the student guidance committee were erased. This was a noticeable change, as no student who had been penalized by the student guidance committee has ever been allowed to be a part of the student body.

This controversy was a hot potato during the most recent election, as one of the candidates had been previously penalized by the committee. As the student body is representative of all students, some students argued it would be inappropriate for students who had been previously penalized to the strongest degree to take the job, while others argued leadership qualities and problem-solving abilities are what matters most, not past penalty records.

The former group raised doubts about how earning penalty points is a greater 'crime' than being sent to the student guidance committee, as the school ironically remained to prohibit students with excessive penalty points from running. They also argued that the elimination of penalty records from the student guidance committee are rarely allowed in any school, especially as students sent to the guidance committee are guilty of heavy mistakes, such as cheating.

The 24th student council responded that the intention of such change was to give second chances to those who had been penalized. As they deemed it over-burdensome for a single mistake to impact future school life so drastically (as such records are critical minus points in college admissions), the council argued that such offenders must be given opportunities to look back at themselves and learn not to make the same mistakes again. It firmly upheld the idea that schools function to keep students on the right track—by opening paths instead of closing them. Yet, questions remain regarding the extent to which schools should exercise such leniency. Is it right to give equal opportunities to even those who have largely disrupted order and abused school rules?

As much as students deserve as equal opportunities as possible, we must think about whether the method of doing so is right. Is erasing penalty records on school report cards a fair and just method? If so, can its practice achieve general approval among students? This is a question that would require much debates and discussions for an answer.

Senior Writer
Park Jeong-Bin



WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE EQUAL?

Nowadays in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, feminism movements that campaign for women's rights have actively taken place. Students supporting feminism share posts, give speeches, raise funds, and engage in diverse activities to remind KMLAians of the existing gender inequality in and out of school. Some students have expressed their discomfort toward feminism campaigns, and related topics have induced heated arguments in the 'KMLA Bamboo Forest' Facebook page. The never-ending disputes over such issues certainly imply that students have conflicting viewpoints towards recent incidents.

One post in the 'KMLA Bamboo Forest' Facebook page held complaints about assigning new students to the Department of Physical Education due to its uneven sex ratio. One of the major duties of the Department of Physical Education is arranging chairs for students to sit in before the weekly morning assembly. Upon realizing that over two-thirds of the new freshmen members were female, the department requested the Student Council to reassign some members, as the task was physically easier for male students then females who wear long skirt uniforms. The anonymous complainer seems to misunderstand the conceptual gap between 'difference' and 'discrimination.' Students easily confuse the meaning of gender equality by hastily asserting that men and women should receive 'equal' treatment. Yet, it is important to note that true gender equality starts by accepting physical and biological differences of all genders.

Regardless of such controversies, it is undeniable that women have yet to reach an equal social status as men. Innumerable commercials objectify women for their products, and women are faced with so much unfair dismissal in corporations due to various reasons, especially regarding maternity leaves. Many people still maintain the view that females should be an obedient supporter of her husband or a devoted mother. Even in KMLA, a number of female friends are often sexually harassed by their male counterparts. As 21st waver Ye-jin Lee addressed in her speech, such sexual harassment evidently shows that some students in KMLA are still entrenched in conventional patriarchal values.

What gender equality truly suggests is recognizing the physical, biological differences of men and women and respecting each other with the belief that despite such differences, all genders deserve equal opportunities. We should also admit that KMLA students may not be as mature enough to understand the complex dimensions of gender problems. 22nd waver Choi Yoon-Ah states, "Conducting enough research on the topic before arguing is critical for constructive debates to take place. Especially when arguing about gender equality in KMLA, avoid hasty, unfounded assertions. We should also discuss such problems in a more open environment, since debating behind the curtain has nothing but risks of delivering the wrong points." It is now the time for change—to prioritize our efforts to fully understand the status quo and the arguments from both sides.

Senior Writer
Park Ha-Young



i sound my barbaric yawp

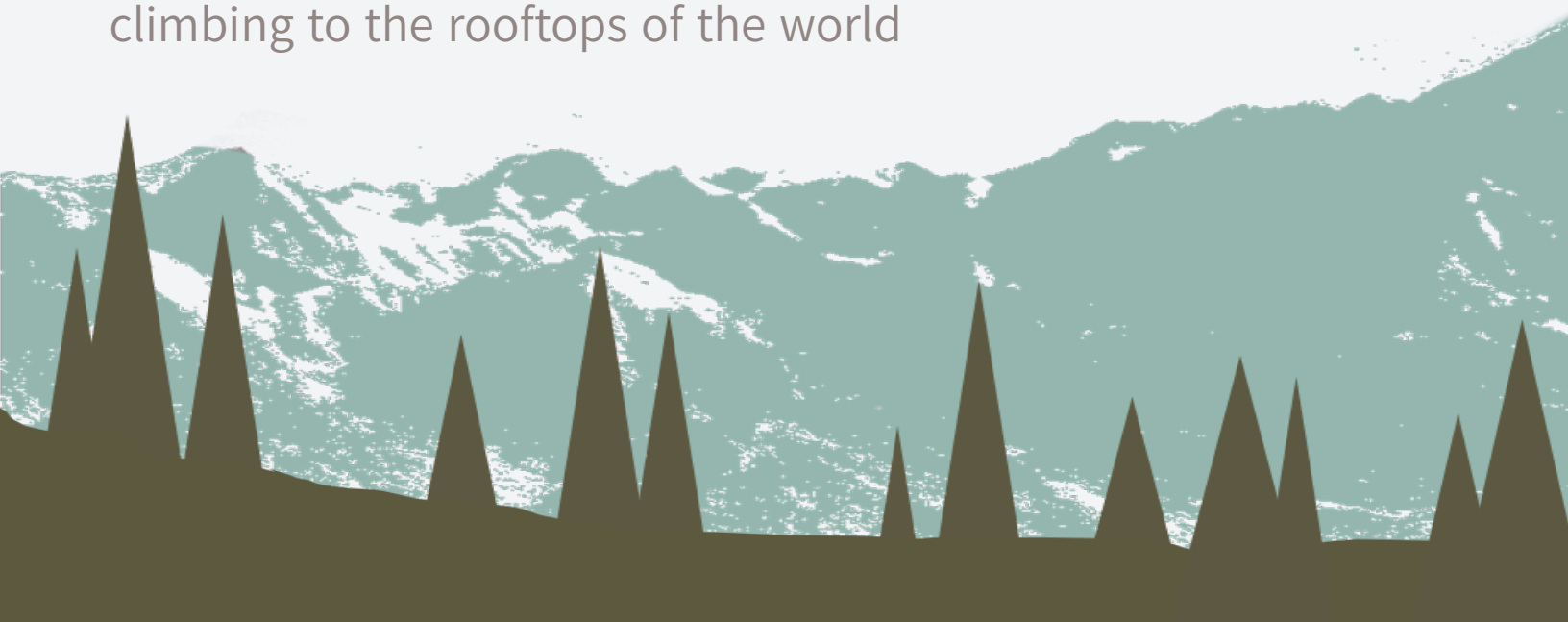
once there was a man
a man with everything else so old,
but eyes full of stars

reeking alcohol, he would seldom tell
“go mount the rooftops and yell,
so loud, to the top of your lungs”

but no one would ever listen
to the inebriated words of his,
for he was no more than a madman

yet was there something so irresistible
that made the words strangely convincing
intoxicating enough, to lead us a way

the moment after, i find myself following
the odd, blurred words of a madman,
climbing to the rooftops of the world



The following poem is inspired from section 52 of Walt Whitman's 'Song of Myself,' in which the famous line "I sound my barbaric yawp over the roofs of the world" leaves the readers with a resonating message of his untranslatable self and his indomitable inner spirit.

and i take a deep breath
the cold, icy breeze piercing through,
standing small yet firm all by myself

and i cannot help but yell,
putting the whole universe under my feet
candid sense of rapture winning over

soaring, roaring so big
i sound my barbaric yawp
over the roofs of the world

a yawp so unadulterated and full
amidst the wide set of mixed feelings
an ardent cry, to sound myself

blood rushing against the cold wind
feeling once again whole and alive
i sound my barbaric yawp once more



NAM HYUN-SOO
22nd wave

ANNUAL MINJOK HERALD LITERARY COMPETITION

Every year, Minjok Herald opens a literary competition for all freshmen, not only staff writers, to present their amazing works and share the excitement of writing. This year's prompt was **'And Then There Were None.'** inspired by Agatha Christie's well-known mystery novel.

Minjok Herald is proud to publish the **poem by the winner of the competition,**

HWANG JEONG-YOON

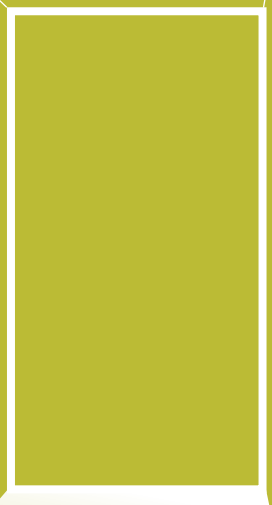
And there were none

In times of despair
We must remember our where
Of the place we have come
To the time we were done

It seemed at the time
Two love birds, happy and fine
Reaching up for the stars
Forever afar

When the tree leaves started to wither away
It must be then when “we” started to fade
One line, now two, in each of our way

Looking back,
The memories once happy and sound
Covered with sorrow, darkness overloom
Where have they gone
Just a midsummer night’s dream
After all this time
Were they actually none?





metanoia

(n.) the journey of changing one's mind, heart, self, or way of life

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